COMPLETE TRAVEL GUIDE

Mammoth Lakes

6 days in Mammoth Lakes built around food and towns, scenic viewpoints, hiking — 14 places chosen from the 23 on your board.

WHEN
10 Jul – 15 Jul 2027

LENGTH
6 days · 5 nights

WHO
2 adults

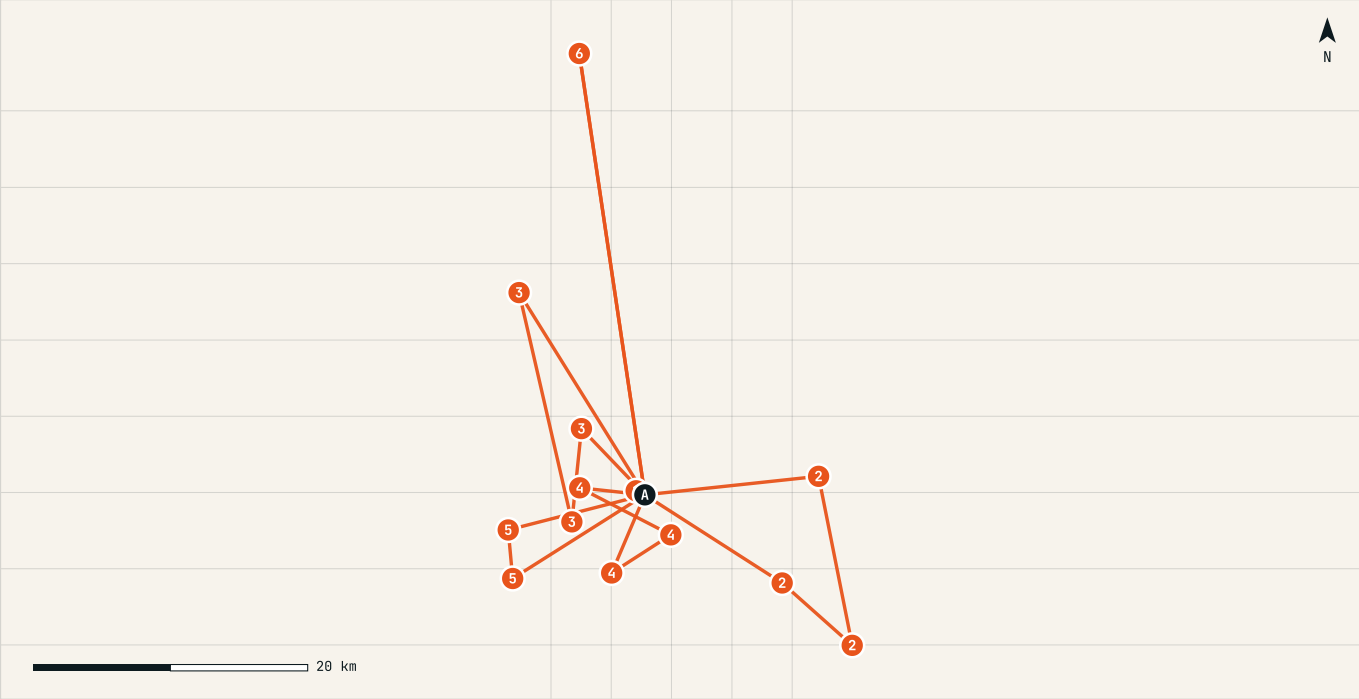
ROUTE
Mammoth Lakes

Planned with Sidequest · 12 November 2026
All times are local (PDT, America/Los_Angeles)

TRIP AT A GLANCE

The shape of the trip

DAYS	STAYS	STOPS	DRIVING
6	1	13	382 km



Letters are where you sleep; numbers are the day each stop falls on. Solid lines follow measured routes; dashed lines are straight connections, not roads.

Where you sleep

A **Mammoth Lakes** · 5 nights · Sat 10 Jul – Thu 15 Jul

Built around

Inyo Craters · Day 3
Two phreatic explosion craters holding milky green ponds, reached by a short climb through pumice and Jeffrey pine.

Panorama Gondola · Day 3
A lift to the 11,053 ft summit of Mammoth Mountain with a view across the Minarets, the Ritter Range and half the Sierra crest — no hiking...

Mammoth Lakes Basin · Day 4
Five alpine lakes strung together ten minutes above town — Twin, Mary, Mamie, George and Horseshoe — with flat shoreline loops and every se...

The Village at Mammoth · Day 1
A core stop, confirmed as a place on the map, on day 1.

Convict Lake · Day 2
A core stop, confirmed as a place on the map, on day 2.

DAY BY DAY

6 days

Times are local (PDT). A time marked ≈ follows a journey estimated from the map; a part of the day stands in where a journey could not be timed.

DAY 1

Saturday 10 July · Mammoth Lakes · Light day · 20 min on the move

Arrive and settle in — The Village at Mammoth

Walk to The Village at Mammoth · ≈ 15 min

≈ 16:15 **1 The Village at Mammoth** · 1 hr 30 min

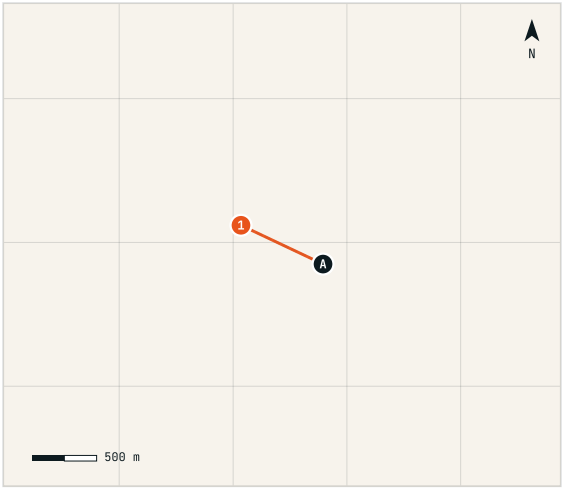
Minutes from where you are staying, so it fits any day.

Drive to Mammoth Lakes · 3 min

≈ 18:00 Dinner — Mammoth Brewing Company

NOTE Travel times on this day are Sidequest's estimates from map distance, not measured routes.

PLAN B Anything that runs late or closes: Keep this afternoon flexible.



DAY 2

Sunday 11 July · Mammoth Lakes · Moderate day · 1 hr 20 min on the move

Convict Lake & McGee Creek Canyon

Drive to Convict Lake · 20 min

09:20 **1 Convict Lake** · 2 hr

A deep blue lake pinned against Laurel Mountain and Mount Morrison, with a flat three-mile shoreline loop that stays good in almost any weather.

Drive to McGee Creek Canyon · 10 min

11:30 **2 McGee Creek Canyon** · 3 hr 30 min

A canyon trail climbing between red and grey metamorphic walls through the best aspen stand in the county — glowing gold for two weeks every autumn.

Drive to Hot Creek Geologic Site · 30 min

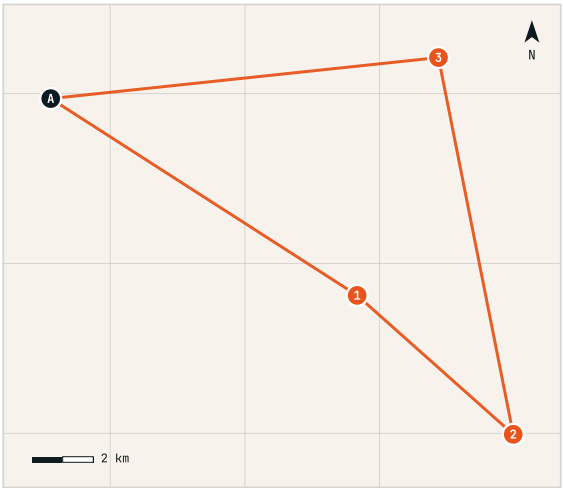
15:25 **3 Hot Creek Geologic Site** · 1 hr

Well off the standard loop — the kind of find you said you wanted.

Drive to Mammoth Lakes · 25 min

16:50 Free time

18:00 Dinner — Roberto's Cafe



PLAN B Rain or strong wind on day 2: Bishop (town and food), close to where you are staying

DAY 3

Monday 12 July · Mammoth Lakes · Full day · 2 hr 25 min on the move

Inyo Craters & Panorama Gondola, Minaret Vista at sunset

Drive to Inyo Craters · 25 min

09:25 **1 Inyo Craters** · 1 hr 15 min

Drive to Panorama Gondola · 40 min

11:20 **2 Panorama Gondola** · 2 hr

A lift to the 11,053 ft summit of Mammoth Mountain with a view across the Minarets, the Ritter Range and half the Sierra crest — no hiking required.

Drive to June Lake Loop · 50 min

14:05 Lunch — June Lake Brewing

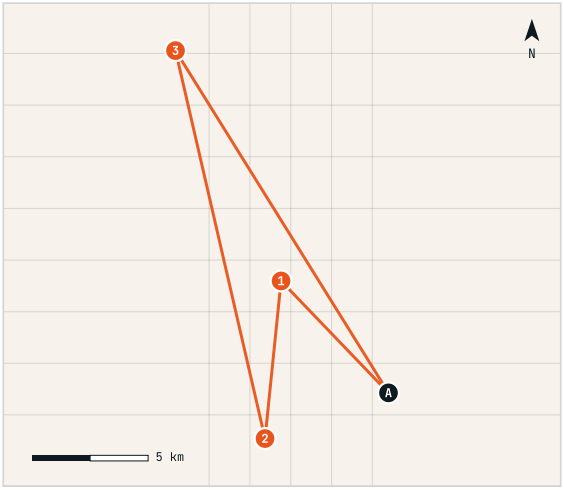
14:50 **3 June Lake Loop** · 3 hr

Sixteen miles of Highway 158 past four lakes and a small ski town wedged under Carson Peak — the drive most people remember from this trip.

Drive to Mammoth Lakes · 35 min

18:25 Dinner — Tiger Bar & Cafe

19:25 Free time



DAY 4

Tuesday 13 July · Mammoth Lakes · Full day · 1 hr 10 min on the move

Mammoth Lakes Basin & Sherwin Lakes Trail

09:00 Breakfast — Early breakfast in Mammoth Lakes before heading out

Drive to Mammoth Lakes Basin · 10 min

09:40 **1 Mammoth Lakes Basin** · 2 hr 30 min

Five alpine lakes strung together ten minutes above town — Twin, Mary, Mamie, George and Horseshoe — with flat shoreline loops and every serious trailhead in the area.

Drive to Sherwin Lakes Trail · 25 min

12:35 Lunch — The Stove

13:20 **2 Sherwin Lakes Trail** · 4 hr

Stays quiet even in season, which matters more to you than a famous name.

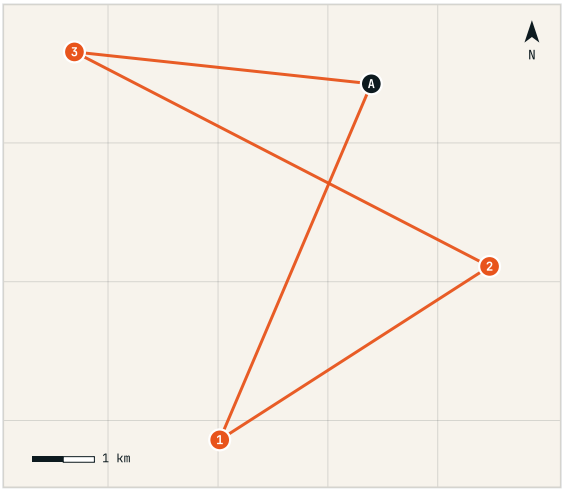
Drive to Earthquake Fault · 25 min

17:45 **3 Earthquake Fault** · 30 min

Holds up even if the weather turns.

Drive to Mammoth Lakes · 10 min

18:25 Dinner — Mammoth Brewing Company



DAY 5

Wednesday 14 July · Mammoth Lakes · Moderate day · 1 hr 40 min on the move

Devils Postpile National Monument & Rainbow Falls

Drive to Devils Postpile National Monument · 45 min

09:45 **1 Devils Postpile National Monument** · 2 hr 30 min
A wall of hexagonal basalt columns left by a lava flow, with a short trail to the top where the column ends look like tiled floor.

Drive to Rainbow Falls · 5 min

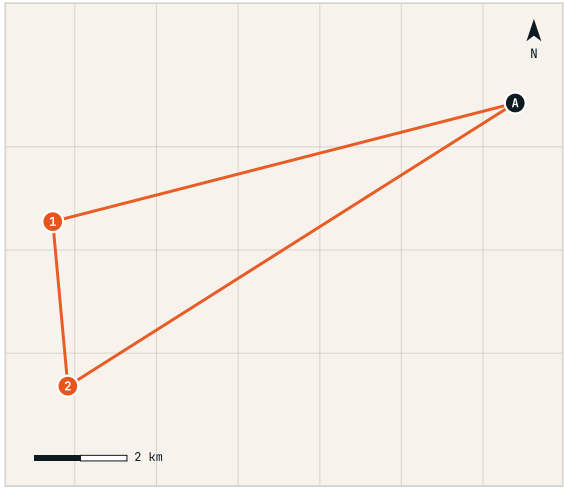
12:20 Lunch — Casual lunch in Reds Meadow Valley, near the midday stop

13:05 **2 Rainbow Falls** · 3 hr 30 min
The San Joaquin drops 101 ft over a lava ledge and throws a rainbow across the spray on sunny summer days.

Drive to Mammoth Lakes · 50 min

17:25 Free time

18:00 Dinner — Roberto's Cafe



DAY 6

Thursday 15 July · Mammoth Lakes · Light day · 1 hr 40 min on the move

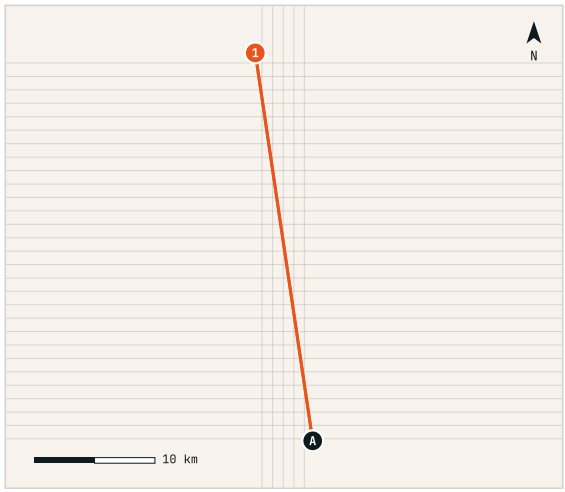
Departure day

05:30 Breakfast — Early breakfast in Mammoth Lakes before heading out

Drive to Mono Lake South Tufa · 50 min

06:50 **1 Mono Lake South Tufa** · 1 hr 30 min
Calcium-carbonate towers standing in a saline lake three times saltier than the ocean, on a flat mile-long interpretive loop through the strangest landscape in the region.

Drive to Mammoth Lakes · 50 min



ACCOMMODATION & TRANSPORT

Where you sleep, and how you move

STAY	NIGHTS	DATES	STATUS
Mammoth Lakes	5	Sat 10 Jul – Thu 15 Jul	TO BOOK

Getting around

- A car: stops sit up to 50 minutes from where you sleep, and a typical day has about 80 minutes of driving against your 150-minute limit.
- Several approach roads here are on the Caltrans District 9 winter closure list and reopen on the snowpack, not on a date.

BOOKINGS & PREPARATION

Before you go

What to book

ITEM	WHEN	WHAT TO DO	STATUS
Rental car for the whole trip Essential	Sat 10 Jul	Book the car, with the insurance excess you are comfortable with	TO BOOK
5 nights in Mammoth Lakes Essential	Sat 10 Jul	Book somewhere to sleep in Mammoth Lakes	TO BOOK

To do before you leave

- [ ] Check the official entry requirements for your nationality before you book anything.
- [ ] McGee Creek Canyon: The trailhead road is not maintained in winter.
- [ ] Hot Creek Geologic Site: The access road is unmaintained in deep winter.
- [ ] Inyo Craters: The forest road in is snow-covered outside summer and autumn.
- [ ] Panorama Gondola: Summer scenic operation runs roughly mid-June to mid-September.
- [ ] June Lake Loop: Caltrans gates the northern half of Highway 158 for winter, usually in November or December.
- [ ] Minaret Vista: Reached via Minaret Summit Road, which is gated by snow through spring.
- [ ] Mammoth Lakes Basin: Lake Mary Road is gated to vehicles for winter; the corridor stays open for non-motorised access and the road reopens...
- [ ] Sherwin Lakes Trail: Snow-free from roughly June through October.
- [ ] Earthquake Fault: On Minaret Road, which closes above town in winter.
- [ ] Passport validity: Add your passport expiry month.
- [ ] Visa or entry permission: Add your citizenship, or check the official source directly.
- [ ] Driving: Confirm licence and IDP rules; decide the rental excess cover.

Packing

ESSENTIAL DOCUMENTS

- [ ] Passport or ID, valid for the trip
- [ ] Printed and offline copies of bookings and documents
- [ ] Driving licence and rental confirmation

CLOTHING

- [ ] Light, breathable clothing and a sun hat

WEATHER

- [ ] Sunscreen and sunglasses
- [ ] Waterproof shell
- [ ] Windproof layer

FOOTWEAR

- [ ] Broken-in hiking boots or trail shoes

OUTDOOR

- [ ] Daypack, water bottle, blister care
- [ ] Trail snacks
- [ ] Trekking poles (optional)

FOR THE ACTIVITIES

- [ ] Swimwear and a quick-dry towel

ELECTRONICS

- [ ] Power bank
- [ ] Car charger

HEALTH AND TOILETRIES

- [ ] Small first-aid kit with blister care
- [ ] Insect repellent (optional)

TRANSPORT

- [ ] Offline maps for the whole route

REMOTE TRAVEL

- [ ] Two litres of water per person on trail days
- [ ] Downloaded plan, maps and emergency numbers

PRACTICAL REFERENCE

Keep this page handy

EMERGENCY **911**

The general emergency number in United States. Confirm locally; reference facts compiled by Sidequest.

DRIVING
On the right

MONEY
USD

PLUGS
Type A, B · 120 V

CALLING CODE
+1

TIME ZONE
PDT · America/Los_Angeles

Scan to open

This trip in Sidequest
Your live copy: changes, Today view and offline pages.

Read-only copy for companions
Anyone with this link can read the plan.
`localhost:4500/share/guideShareTestToken0001`

Day 1 in Google Maps
The Village at Mammoth

Day 2 in Google Maps
3 stops, in order

Day 3 in Google Maps
3 stops, in order

Day 4 in Google Maps
3 stops, in order

Day 5 in Google Maps
2 stops, in order

Day 6 in Google Maps
Mono Lake South Tufa

APPENDIX

Planning notes and reference

How this plan was put together

One base in Mammoth Lakes; each day's stops are grouped so you are not crossing back and forth.

Opening hours and access are checked when the plan is built where a provider has them; check the rest before you go.

Worth skipping, for how you travel

- **Alabama Hills** — 2 hr 15 min each way by car is past how far you said you would go.
- **Wild Willy's Hot Spring** — A close match for what you said you care about.
- **Manzanar National Historic Site** — A close match for what you said you care about.
- **Obsidian Dome** — A close match for what you said you care about.
- **Manzanar Visitor Center** — Holds up when the weather does not.
- **Bodie State Historic Park** — A close match for what you said you care about.

Budget estimate (USD)

Lodging 5 nights × one room at a midrange band	450–950
Food 6 days of everyday meals at a midrange band, plus one meal worth booking	280–580 pp
Activities 1 stop that usually charge entry	15–45 pp
Car fuel tolls parking 6 rental days plus fuel for about 382 km of measured driving	368–736
Miscellaneous A small daily allowance for the unplanned	30–90 pp
Estimated total	**USD 1,468–3,116**

Figures are in US dollars. Estimates only; no price on this page was checked live.

Positions

Type a pair into any map app's search box.

1	The Village at Mammoth	37.6512,-118.9793
2	Convict Lake	37.5906,-118.8583
2	McGee Creek Canyon	37.5497,-118.8003
2	Hot Creek Geologic Site	37.6606,-118.8281
3	Inyo Craters	37.6919,-119.0247
3	Panorama Gondola	37.6308,-119.0326
3	June Lake Loop	37.7811,-119.0764
4	Mammoth Lakes Basin	37.5972,-118.9997
4	Sherwin Lakes Trail	37.6222,-118.9506
4	Earthquake Fault	37.6531,-119.0261
5	Devils Postpile National Monument	37.6255,-119.0854
5	Rainbow Falls	37.5936,-119.0817
6	Mono Lake South Tufa	37.9375,-119.0264

Credits

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